Ayush Shahi

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Position

Jul 2026 – **Predoctoral Research Professional**, Development Innovation Lab
University of Chicago, PI: Michael Kremer

Education

2025 – 2026 **M.A. International and Development Economics**, Yale University

2024 – 2025 **Postgraduate Diploma in Advanced Economics**, Ashoka University
CGPA 4.0/4.0, Summa Cum Laude, ranked 1st in cohort

2021 – 2024 **B.Sc. (Hons.) Economics and Finance**, Ashoka University
CGPA 3.85/4.0, Magna Cum Laude

2023 **Summer School, International Economics**, London School of Economics

Working Papers

[1] Sticky Hierarchies: How Caste Norms Bound Gender Progress in India (with Ashwini Deshpande) [PDF]

Undergraduate Publications

[2] Can Digital Payment Adoption Reduce Crime? Empirical Evidence from India (with Hiba Hasan and Sahil Garud). *Ramjas Economic Review*, 7(1): 1–10. [PDF]
Best Paper Award, Ramjas Economic Review Paper Presentation Competition, 2025

Research Experience

2025 – 2026 **Research Assistant** to José-Antonio Espín-Sánchez, Economic Growth Center, Yale University

2024 – 2025 **Research Assistant** to Ashwini Deshpande, Department of Economics, Ashoka University

2024 **Research Intern**, Good Business Lab

2022 – 2023 **Research Analyst**, Centre for New Economic Studies, O.P. Jindal University

Honors & Awards

2025 Inlaks Scholarship for graduate study at Yale, The Inlaks Shivdasani Foundation

2025 Economics Department Merit Award (1st rank), Ashoka University

Teaching

2024 Urban Economics (UG, Ashoka University), TA for Lalit Contractor

Service

2025 Mentor, Bahujan Economists

2024 – 2025 Student Mentor, Eklavya India Foundation

Other

2023	Treasury Intern, IDBI Bank Ltd., Mumbai
2022	Summer Intern, Strategy Consulting, Ernst & Young, Mumbai

Skills

Programming	Stata, LaTeX, R, Python
Languages	English (fluent), Hindi (native)
GRE	334/340 (Quant 169, Verbal 165)

Last updated: October 13, 2026